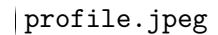


Dr.-Ing. Salar Mohtaj

Senior Applied Scientist | AI & NLP



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Profile

Experienced AI/NLP professional with 8+ years in **Data Analytics**, **Business Intelligence**, and **Reporting**, specializing in leveraging **AI/ML** for **data-driven decision-making**. Expertise includes **LLM evaluation**, **transfer learning**, **multilingual NLP**, and developing **evaluation methodologies** for complex systems. Proven ability to translate **complex business requirements** into **actionable insights**, build **KPI frameworks**, and automate **reporting pipelines** through rapid prototyping, **dataset creation**, and **production-oriented data pipelines**.

Knowledge & Skills

Data Analytics & BI: Data Analysis, Business Intelligence, Reporting, KPI Frameworks, Data Visualization, Business Understanding, AI-powered Analysis, Scalable Data Processes, Forecasting, Funnel Analysis, Performance Management

Large Language Models: LLM Evaluation, Prompt Engineering, Mechanistic Interpretability, RAG Systems, AI Safety, Human-in-the-Loop Evaluation

NLP & Machine Learning: Transfer Learning, Text Simplification, Readability Assessment, Harmful Content Detection, Semantic Similarity, Multilingual NLP

Frameworks & Engineering: PyTorch, Hugging Face Transformers, LangChain, LlamaIndex, Promptfoo, FastAPI, MLflow, Docker, AWS

Programming: Python, SQL, R, Excel

Languages: English (C1/C2), German (B2), Persian/Farsi (Native)

Experience

Senior Research Scientist

Dec 2019 – Dec 2025

German Research Center for Artificial Intelligence (DFKI)

Berlin, Germany

- Led development of **data-driven evaluation methodologies** and **KPI frameworks** for generative models, establishing **multilingual assessment pipelines** to provide **business insights**.
- Designed **benchmark-driven evaluation frameworks** and **dashboards** for NLG systems, incorporating **automated reporting** and **performance management** for **data-driven decisions**.
- Developed industrial LLM training programs, translating complex AI concepts into practical applications and collaborating with **stakeholders** to define **reporting standards** and **control logics**.
- Conducted **data analysis** for NLP research on readability assessment and text simplification, identifying **efficiency potentials** for German-language accessibility applications.

Research Scientist

Mar 2019 – Dec 2019

Technische Universität Berlin

Berlin, Germany

- Developed TextComplexityDE, a large-scale **dataset** for German readability assessment, involving **data extraction**, **preparation**, and **analysis** for **business insights**.
- Designed and taught an online NLP course, effectively communicating complex analytical results to a broad audience.

- Investigated **data-driven transfer learning** approaches for multilingual and low-resource NLP applications, identifying **patterns** and **efficiency potentials**.

NLP Researcher & Developer
ICT Research Institute of ACECR

Apr 2014 – Feb 2019
 Tehran, Iran

- Developed Hamtajoo, a large-scale **data analysis platform** for plagiarism detection, utilizing **semantic similarity methods** to identify **patterns** and **deviations**.
- Created Parsivar, an open-source Persian NLP toolkit, enhancing **data quality** and **availability** for linguistic preprocessing.
- Built **scalable data processes** and machine learning pipelines for Persian educational technology and NLP applications, supporting **data-driven steering**.

Selected Projects

Interpreting and Steering Large Language Models

2025 – Present

- Investigating **AI-powered analysis** techniques for understanding internal representations in transformer-based language models, identifying **patterns** and **insights**.
- Developing methods for controllable generation and neuron-level behavioral steering, contributing to **performance management** and **process optimization**.

German Text Complexity Assessment & Simplification

2021 – 2025

- Developed explainable NLP pipelines for **data analysis** of German text complexity, generating **insights** for simplified text variants.
- Applied transformer-based multi-task learning approaches for readability assessment, contributing to **data-driven decisions** in accessibility.

Education

PhD in Computer Engineering
Technische Universität Berlin

2020 – 2024
 Berlin, Germany

- Dissertation: *Transfer Learning for Harmful Content Detection*

MSc in Information Technology
Amirkabir University of Technology

2011 – 2014
 Tehran, Iran

BSc in Information Technology
Shahrood University of Technology

2006 – 2011
 Shahrood, Iran

Selected Publications [full list]

- **Mohtaj**, S. *Transfer Learning for Harmful Content Detection*. Springer, 2025.
- **Mohtaj** et al. “NewsPolyML: Multi-lingual European News Fake Assessment Dataset.” ACM Multimedia AI Against Disinformation Workshop, 2024.
- **Mohtaj** et al. “Multi-Task Learning for German Text Readability.” CLiC-it, 2024.
- Yang, **Mohtaj**, et al. “Order in the Evaluation Court: A Critical Analysis of NLG Evaluation Trends.” ACL 2026 (under review).

Open Source & Academic Activities

- Software Campus Fellow — Selected for Germany's national leadership and research funding program for outstanding IT researchers.
- Program Committee Member — KlarText Workshop on German Text Simplification.
- Creator and maintainer of Parsivar, an open-source Persian NLP toolkit for text preprocessing.
- Supervised 50+ Bachelor's and Master's theses in NLP, machine learning, and AI-related topics, fostering **data analysis** and **business understanding** skills.